

Challenge: Insp3ct0r

Category: Web Exploitation

Description: The flag was split into three parts, hidden across different areas of a webpage's code — not visible directly on the rendered page itself.

Approach: I used two different inspection methods to locate all three parts. View Page Source revealed Part 1, embedded in the raw HTML. Using the browser's Inspect tool, I found Part 2 hidden in the CSS and Part 3 hidden in the JavaScript. Combining all three parts in order gave the complete flag.

Difficulty Faced: Using only Inspect initially, I found Parts 2 and 3 but couldn't locate Part 1 — it turned out to be in the raw HTML source, visible only through View Page Source rather than the Inspect/DevTools view. Realizing I needed to check both methods, not just one, was the key step to finding all three parts.

Tools used: Browser Inspect (DevTools), View Page Source

Flag: academy{tru3_d3t3ct1ve_0r_ju5t_lucky?d04ce271}

What I learned: A single flag can be deliberately scattered across different parts of a page's code — not just HTML, but CSS and JavaScript too. View Page Source and Inspect aren't interchangeable: View Source shows the original file exactly as the server sent it, while Inspect shows the live, rendered DOM and lets you browse linked CSS/JS files separately. A thorough approach checks both, since something hidden in one won't necessarily show up in the other.